

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

INTERNAL SECURITY - 3

Forces and their Mandate

Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF)

They operate under the Ministry of Home affairs. Each of the forces is led by an IPS officer with the notable exception of the Assam Rifles which is headed by an Army officer of the rank of Lieutenant General. Central Armed Police Forces were formerly referred to as Paramilitary Forces. From March 2011, the Ministry of Home Affairs adopted a uniform nomenclature of Central Armed Police Forces to avoid confusion. There are seven central armed police forces. Each of these forces performs a separate function.

Seven Paramilitary Forces of India are:

1. Assam Rifles
2. Border Security Force (BSF)
3. Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)
4. Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)
5. Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBF)
6. National Security Guard (NSG)
7. Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)

Assam Rifles:

1. The Assam Rifles was established in 1835.
2. It is considered the oldest of all paramilitary forces and one of the six Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF).
3. This force plays a crucial role in North East India, handling counterinsurgency and border security operations. They are also guarding the 1,643 km long Indo-Myanmar border since 2002.
4. It is headed by an Army officer of the rank of Lieutenant General. It currently reports to the Ministry of Home Affairs.
5. It is the only paramilitary force with a dual control structure. The administrative control of Assam Rifles is with MHA while the operational control is with the Ministry of Defence.
6. It is often referred to as the "Friends of the Hill People", "Friends of the North East People" and the "Sentinels of the North East".
7. It remains the most awarded paramilitary force in both pre-and post-independent India.

Border Security Force (BSF):

1. The BSF is the border guards of the country and is called the 'India's First Line of Defence.' It came into being in the wake of the 1965 Indo-Pakistan war. It was established on 1st December 1965.
2. It is under the administrative control of Ministry of Home Affairs
3. It also undertakes defensive actions during wartime to free up Indian Army troops for offensive operations.
4. Of late, the BSF has also been tasked with assisting the CRPF and army in counter-insurgency operations.

Central Industrial Security Force (CISF):

1. Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) was established in 1969, under an Act of Parliament, "Central Industrial Security Force Act, 1968."
2. It provides integrated security cover to the Public Sector Undertakings, airports and SEZs on a case-to-case basis.
3. It is currently providing security cover to nuclear installations, space establishments, airports, seaports, power plants, sensitive Government buildings, heritage monuments and large special economic zones.
4. CISF is also responsible to provide protection to the persons classified as Z Plus, Z, X, Y. CISF is a compensatory cost force.

Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF):

1. The Central Reserve Police Force was established by the enactment of the CRPF Act in 1949.
2. The primary mission of the Central Reserve Police Force is counter-insurgency operations.
3. It also assists the State and Union Territories in police operations to maintain law and order.
4. Apart from this, the force participates as a police force in the UN peace-keeping missions.
5. The CRPF maintains a special operation unit known as Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (COBRA) to combat Maoist insurgents.

Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP):

1. The Indo-Tibetan Border Police was created under the CRPF Act. It was established on 24th October 1962 after the 1962 Sino-Indian conflict.
2. It guards the Indo-Tibetan border and the mountainous regions of the India-China border and monitors the northern borders.
3. ITBP replaced Assam Rifles in Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh in 2004. The Indo-China border covering the following state is guarded by the ITBP (From the Karakoram Pass in Jammu & Kashmir to Jechap La in Arunachal Pradesh): Jammu & Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh
4. The force also keeps a check on illegal immigration and trans-border smuggling.
5. It has been deployed in UN peacekeeping missions in Kosovo, Sierra Leone, Haiti, Western Sahara, Bosnia, Herzegovina, Afghanistan and Sudan.

Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)

1. The Sashastra Seema Bal was set up in March 1963.
2. They guard Indo-Nepal and Indo-Bhutan Borders.
3. It also acts against smuggling and other illegal activities.

Intelligence Bureau:

1. Intelligence Bureau is the domestic internal security and counter intelligence agency under ministry of Home Affairs.
2. It was founded in 1887 by the British for Monitoring Russian troop deployments in Afghanistan so as to avoid an invasion of British India from the North West.
3. After 1909, its mandate was expanded to keep an eye on Indian revolutionaries.
4. It is the oldest such organization in the world.

5. Until 1968, it handled both domestic and foreign intelligence after which research and analysis wing was formed specifically for foreign intelligence.

Research and Analysis Wing:

1. The Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) is the foreign intelligence agency of India.
2. The agency's primary function is gathering foreign intelligence, counter-terrorism, counter-proliferation, advising Indian policymakers, and advancing India's foreign strategic interests.
3. It is also involved in the security of India's nuclear programme.
4. It came into existence in 1968, as a brainchild of **R N Kao**, then a deputy director of the intelligence Bureau.
5. The head of R&AW is designated as the Secretary (Research) in the Cabinet Secretariat, and is under the authority of the Prime Minister of India without parliamentary oversight.
6. On an administrative basis, the Director reports to the Cabinet Secretary, who reports to the Prime Minister.

National Security Guards

1. The NSG was established in the wake of Operation Blue Star of 1984. During this operation the central government desperately needed to have a special force to tackle terror activities.
2. NSG came into existence on September 22, 1986 as the federal contingency world class Zero Error Force to deal with anti-terrorist activities in all its manifestations.
3. It is modelled on the pattern of SAS of the UK and GSG-9 of Germany. It has two complementary elements. Special Action Group (SAG) comprising of Army personnel and Special Ranger Group (SRG), comprising personnel drawn from CAPF/State Police.
4. NSG has five commando hubs (Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata and Ahmedabad) apart from Delhi.
- 5.

Functions of National Security Guard (NSG)

1. Counter hijacking tasks on land, sea, and air
2. Bomb disposal (search, detection and neutralization of IEDs)
3. Post Blast Investigation (PBI)
4. Hostage Rescue missions like in Taj Hotel during 26/11 Mumbai attack
5. VIP security (like security to Cabinet Ministers and others eminent persons)

National Investigation Agency:

The Agency came into existence with the enactment of the **National Investigation Agency Act 2008** by the Parliament of India on 31 December 2008, which was passed after the deadly 26/11 terror attack in Mumbai.

It aims to set the standards of excellence in counter terrorism and other national security related investigations at the national level by developing into a highly trained, partnership-oriented workforce. NIA aims at creating deterrence for existing and potential terrorist groups/individuals. It aims to develop as a storehouse of all terrorist related information.

Mission

- In-depth professional investigation of scheduled offences using the latest scientific methods of investigation and setting up such standards as to ensure that all cases entrusted to the NIA are detected.
- Inducting modern methods and latest technology in every sphere of activities of the agency.
- Assist all States and other investigating agencies in investigation of terrorist cases.
- Build a data base on all terrorist related information and share the data base available with the States and other agencies.
- Study and analyse laws relating to terrorism in other countries and regularly evaluate the adequacy of existing laws in India and propose changes as and when necessary.

Amendments to NIA Act in 2019:

1. It extends NIA jurisdiction to investigate the following offences (i) human trafficking, (ii) offences related to counterfeit currency or bank notes, (iii) manufacture or sale of prohibited arms, (iv) cyber-terrorism, and (v) offences under the Explosive Substances Act, 1908.
2. It empowers NIA to investigate scheduled offences committed outside India, subject to international treaties and domestic laws of other countries.
3. the central government may designate Sessions Courts as Special Courts for the trial of scheduled offences, after consulting the Chief Justice of the High Court concerned. State governments may also designate Sessions Courts as Special Courts for the trial of scheduled offences.

Defence Modernization

The Global Firepower Index report lists Indian military as the fourth most-powerful military after USA, Russia, and China.

With a budget of \$74.3 billion (2024), it is third-largest defence budget in the world after USA and China.

Total personnel: Army- 11,89,368; Air Force: 1,50,840; Navy: 74,615

As of December 2021, the percentages of women serving across all ranks in the Army, Navy and Air Force are 0.59%, 6.0% and 1.08% respectively.

Challenges:

1. A two and a half front threat.
2. Tension along borders with two nuclear-armed neighbours, who are strong allies.
3. **Declining defence budget:** Defence expenditure as a percentage of GDP declined from 2.4% in 2011-12 to 2.1% in 2021-22. The Standing Committee on Defence (2018) had recommended a fixed budget of about 3% of GDP to ensure adequate preparedness of the armed forces.
4. **Shortfall between demand and allocation:** The average shortfall between amount projected by three forces and the actual expenditure between 2015-16 and 2019-20 for revenue expenditure was 14% while for capital expenditure it was 38%.
5. **Reduction in capital outlay:** The share of capital outlay has also decreased within the defence budget from 30% in 2011-12 to 22% in 2018-19 while share of pensions increased from 18% to 26%.
6. **Low Capital Expenditure:** For 2021-22, 54% of defence budget was for salaries and pensions and only 27% for capital outlay.
7. **High Import dependence:** Between 2018-22, India was world's largest defence importer at 11% of total global imports (SIPRI).

8. Undermarketed borders, territorial disputes and frequent attempts of infiltration.
9. Substandard infrastructure and connectivity in the border region.
10. Lack of jointness across forces.
11. **Personnel shortage:** Three armed forces have a shortage of 1,35,784 personnel, including officers and soldiers. The maximum vacancies of 1,16,464 are in Indian Army followed by 13,597 in Indian Navy and 5,723 in the Indian Air Force.

A number of committees like Kargil review Committee, Naresh Chandra Task Force and Shekatkat Committee have given a number of suggestions including increasing defence budget to 2.5-3% of GDP, creating the post of Chief of Defence Staff (CDS), reducing the average age, improving teeth-to-tail ratio, creation of theatre commands etc. for modernization of defence forces.

Recent Steps for modernization:

1. **Office of Chief of defence staff** has been created to improve jointness between forces and give a boost to indigenization of defence platforms.
2. Creation of new **Department of Military Affairs** for better management of military resources and procurement.
3. **Domain-specific joint commands** like Defence Cyber Agency, Defence space Agency, Special operations Division created to improve jointness in specialized sectors. Each of these will be headed by a two- star officer.
4. **Corporatisation of Ordnance Factory Boards (OFBs)** to improve their functioning and efficiency.
5. Women have been inducted into all three wings of the Armed Forces.
6. In September 2019, government finalized to spend \$130 billion in 5 to 7 years to modernize the armed forces. The plan includes the acquisition of a range of weapon includes warship, missile, drone, fighter jet, surveillance equipment, rifle and creating architecture for artificial intelligence.
7. A separate fund has been earmarked for supporting the start-ups under **IDEX (Scheme for Innovations in Defence Excellence)** and MSMEs for the development of design and new technology in the defence and aerospace sector.
8. The government has agreed to the 15th Finance Commission recommendation to constitute a **Modernisation Fund for Defence and Internal Security (MFDIS)**, a non-lapsable dedicated fund to bridge the gap between projected budgetary requirements and allocation for internal security and defence.
9. **Defence acquisition procedure (DAP-2020)** has been amended and new categories like Buy (Indian-IDD), buy (-global manufacturer in India), Make-II etc. have been incorporated focused on boosting indigenous production capabilities, reducing arms import and encouraging foreign companies to setup production facilities in India.
10. In 2021, more than 70,000 crore (63%) of defence capital outlay were reserved for domestic industry.
11. Negative arms import list has been created progressively banning acquisition of specific weapon systems.

Chief of Defence Staff

- Heads the Department of Military Affairs.
- Principle advisor to the defence minister on matter involving three services.
- First among equals and is of the rank of Secretary within department of defence.
- Permanent chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee.

12. Liberalisation of Defence Sector: FDI limit increased to 74% from earlier 49% in defence production through automatic clearance route.

Theatre commands:

A theatre command *is an* organisational structure designed to control all military assets in a theatre of war *to achieve* military effects.

- Theatre commands bring the separate arms of the military under a single-unified command structure.
- Theatre commands operate under a single commander for a specific geographical region.
- These enable the military to combine resources and optimally use them for offensive and defensive operations.
- Almost all major countries like China, Russia, the US, the UK and France work on a theatre command concept.
- In India, the Indian Army and Indian Air Force have seven commands each while the Indian Navy has three commands. There are two joint services commands, the first one is Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC) and the second, being Strategic Forces Command (SFC).

Benefits:

- It will promote 'jointness' among the three branches of the armed forces.
- It will ensure increased coordination to boost the overall fighting capabilities of the Indian armed forces.
- Create capacities to adapt to the requirements of hybrid warfare along with seamless command centres to meet future challenges.

Challenges:

- The three service chiefs are protective of respective turfs and perpetuate a single-service approach to training, planning and operations.
- Hurdles related to operational command and control over assets.
- Challenges related to Budgetary allocations, fund distribution and assets between the army, navy and air force for seamless operation.
- Absence of National Security Doctrine will create challenge to a clarity of purpose behind jointness.

Defence Exports:

- Defence exports have increased from 686 crores in 2013-14 to estimated Rs. 21,083 crores in 2023-24.
- India is exporting to more than 90 countries, and more than 100 firms are currently engaged in defence product exports. USA has emerged as biggest export destination accounting for around 50% of India's total defence exports..
- Key Exports: Dornier-228, 155 mm Advanced Towed Artillery Guns (ATAGs), Brahmos Missiles, Akash Missile System, Radars, Simulators, Mine Protected Vehicles, Armoured Vehicles, PINAKA Rockets & Launchers, Ammunitions, Thermal Imagers, Body Armours etc.
- India has signed some big-ticket standalone deals, like the BrahMos contract with the Philippines and for artillery guns and air defence systems with Armenia.

NOTE: The government of India has fixed a target to increase defence exports to Rs 35-40,000 crore and a turnover of Rs 1.75 lakh crore (\$25 billion) in defence manufacturing by 2025.

Defence Indigenisation

- The expenditure on defence procurement from foreign sources has reduced from **46% (2018-19) to 36.7% (December 2022)**, reflecting a shift towards self-reliance and indigenous manufacturing capabilities.
- **Notable indigenous productions:** Aircraft such as the Dornier-228, artillery guns, Brahmos Missiles, PINAKA rockets and launchers, radars, simulators, and armoured vehicles.

Policy Initiatives:

- Ministry of Defence has set a target of achieving a **turnover of \$25 Bn** in aerospace and defence Manufacturing by 2025, which includes **\$5 Bn exports**. Till October 2022, a total of 595 Industrial Licences have been issued to 366 companies operating in Defence Sector.
- Under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat Initiative**, **four positive indigenization lists of 411 products** have been promulgated to be manufactured domestically, instead of being imported.
- **Defence Acquisition Procedure (DAP 2020)** has laid down a strict order of preference for procurement with focus on domestic industry through Make in India.
- **Strategic Partnership Model (SPM)** for Indian companies to partner with global OEMs (Original Equipment Manufacturer) for big ticket military contracts seeking technology transfer and manufacturing know-how.
- DRDO's **Technology Development Fund (TDF)** for MSMEs & Start-ups to indigenize cutting-edge defence technologies.
- **SRIJAN** portal launched to promote indigenization. 27130 defence items 19509 defence items, have been displayed on the portal for indigenisation.

Agnipath Scheme:

The scheme provides for Agniveers to join the three forces for four years. After four years, only 25% of the batch will be recruited back into their respective services, for a period of 15 years.

Objectives:

- Provides opportunity for a bigger number of motivated youths to join the armed forces.
- Expected to reduce the average age profile of armed forces (presently 32 Years) by 4-5 years (around 26 years) in six-seven years.
- This will reduce the overall salary and pension burden of ministry of defence.
- Upon the completion of the 4-years of service, a one-time 'Seva Nidhi' package of Rs 11.71 lakhs will be paid to the Agniveers that will include their accrued interest thereon.

Challenges:

- Lack of job security may deter youth from looking Agnipath scheme as a career option.
- Defence veterans have argued that deployment of 'temporary soldiers' may weaken India's defence along the China and Pakistan borders.
- Those leaving after four years, will have limited career options as a second job.

- A group of highly trained but unemployed youth might create challenges to the society.

In order to improve future prospects of non-inducted Agniveers, 10% reservation has been provided in BSF and CISF recruitments. State governments like Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Odisha have announced reservation to Agniveers in state jobs on priority basis. Private business groups have also shown interest in employing them.

The army is conducting internal review of the scheme to further improve the attractiveness and efficacy of the scheme.